



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Crossroads Christian Academy
School Website: <https://crossroadschristianacademyaz.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Crossroads Christian Academy AZ presents a robust classical-Christian profile, with explicit commitments to Christ-centered classical education, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books and the Great Conversation, and a biblically grounded worldview embedded in all classroom life. Public materials on the school's site emphasize a formation-focused aim (virtue, wisdom, human flourishing) and a pedagogy that blends contemplative, memory-rich lower-division practice with Socratic/seminar-oriented upper-division work. The school also foregrounds partnership with families, reverence and church-life integration, and a clearly defined code of ethics and governance structure. Taken together, these elements align strongly with a classical education framework, particularly one that is explicitly theological and liturgically articulated.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key evidence highlights include: mission statements that describe a Christ-centered, classical education (with emphasis on formation and lifelong learning) and the explicit framing of truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendent standards rooted in God (supported by direct statements in FAQ materials and a formal Statement of Faith) . The curriculum is published to center grammar-logic-rhetoric (the Trivium), the Great Books approach, and Western civilization—elements central to classical education (e.g., "BEGINNING GRAMMAR ... GRAMMAR SCHOOL ... LOGIC SCHOOL ... RHETORIC SCHOOL" and Great Books references) . Faculty and governance materials (board portraits and staff statements) reinforce the living-lesson/church-mentorship model, while parent-partnership and devotional formation are repeatedly foregrounded in policy and mission materials . These signals collectively underpin an overall CLASSICAL rating, with notable strengths in explicit religious/metaphysical foundations, curriculum, pedagogy, and community involvement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Notes on the keyword approach: - Positive keywords drawn from the Six Essential Elements and their Lexicon emphasize truth, goodness, beauty; theology and sacred scripture; liturgy; formation; great books; the trivium; and the integration of faith with learning. The Crossroads materials repeatedly invoke these terms or closely related concepts (e.g., Christ-centered, classical education, Great Books, Trivium, reverence, liturgical language, and a mission centered on Scripture) and show explicit programs and policies that align with those keywords. Negative keywords (secular, value-neutral, etc.) are largely absent from the school's public materials, which reinforces the CLASSICAL classification. - Citations reflect specific textual evidence from the Crossroads Christian Academy AZ materials and the classical-element lexicon, including direct mission/faith statements and curricular descriptions.

Now, the category-by-category evaluation with evidence, keyword analysis, and ratings.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission and identity statements foreground a Christ-centered, biblically grounded education. The mission explicitly identifies Crossroads as providing a distinctively Christ-centered, academically excellent, classical education as a foundation for life-long learning, guiding all curriculum and practice (Mission statements and policy manual). - The school asserts a Statement of Faith with explicit Christian doctrinal content (Old Roman Creed; Trinity; Christ's kingship; Scripture as authoritative) and a requirement for faculty/staff to subscribe to core Christian beliefs. - The motto *Veritas Vos Liberabit* ("The Truth Will Set You Free") and references to truth, faith, and sacred scriptural interpretation anchor the metaphysical framework. - Great Books / Great Conversation language appears in public materials as part of the classical program (via FAQs and mission materials that foreground reading and discussion of foundational texts).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; theology; sacred scripture; liturgy; reverence; wonder; logos; Scriptural centrality; Christian worldview; sacred tradition; the Great Books; great conversation; formation through faith. - Negative keywords present: essentially none in public materials (no explicit secularism, secular humanism, or values-neutral language detected in the sources summarized here).

Why this rating - The explicit articulation of a Christian worldview integrated into curriculum, worship/faith life, and governance, plus direct statements about theology, Scripture, and liturgy, strongly align with the Positive/Negative keyword framework for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The presence of a doctrinal creed and a mission centered on truth-hope-beauty within a sacred framework signals CLASSICAL with a theologically saturated basis, not a secular or agnostic model.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The stated goal is formation of virtue and wisdom within a classical framework, not merely information or job preparation. The mission emphasizes a "distinctively Christ-centered, academically excellent, classical education as a foundation for lifelong learning" and a formation-oriented aim (not purely career preparation). - The Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis and the commitment to truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendent standards (as described in FAQ/mission content) align with formation and telos-focused aims rather than purely information transfer. - The formation-oriented language (e.g., the emphasis on "formation" and "virtue" in the public materials and policy) is reinforced by the lexicon's category on Formation and Virtue, which includes language around the cultivation of wisdom and moral imagination.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, cultivate virtue, wisdom, telos, love of learning, great conversation, classical mission, moral imagination, virtue ethics, wisdom, formation of the soul. - Negative keywords present: minimal or no presence of "workforce/career readiness," "21st-century skills," or other modern utilitarian framing in the public materials reviewed.

Why this rating - The school consistently emphasizes formation and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as the objective of education and societal formation, consistent with classical-pedagogical aims rather than a purely utilitarian trajectory. The explicit commitment to formation and classical aims signals CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Trivium is explicitly defined and taught as the core framework: BEGINNING GRAMMAR (K-2), GRAMMAR SCHOOL (3-5), LOGIC SCHOOL (6-8), RHETORIC SCHOOL (9-12). This directly mirrors

classical curriculum architecture. - The curriculum centers grammar, logic, and rhetoric, and emphasizes the development and flow of Western civilization (history, science, math, government, art, literature, philosophy, and historic Christian faith). The Great Books and the Great Conversation are highlighted as key components of education, with explicit statements about reading Great Books and engaging with foundational texts. - The policy materials emphasize the Seven Liberal Arts (via the Trivium) and a unified approach to knowledge, including a focus on primary texts and an integrated, interdisciplinary approach to learning.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation; history of Western civilization; interdisciplinary integration; formation through reading primary sources; wonder in learning. - Negative keywords present: minimal to none (no strong signals of “social studies as replacement for history,” no over-emphasis on STEM-first or project-based-only curricula; no indication of secular, non-textual-centric instruction).

Why this rating - The explicit Trivium-based structure, Great Books emphasis, and integrated, historically grounded, virtue-oriented curriculum strongly align with classical-curriculum criteria. The school's public materials articulate a deliberately classical curriculum framework, indicating CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical approach is described with a staged Trivium-based pedagogy and upper-level Socratic/seminar-style discussion (Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates) and rhetoric training at the high school level; honors the idea that lower grades develop memory through chant/singing, and upper grades engage in rhetorical discourse. The Trivium framework includes explicit stages and memory/recitation components. - The lower grades feature contemplative, memory-heavy, and memorization-oriented pedagogy (e.g., singing/recitation), while upper grades emphasize Socratic discussion and rhetorical training, in line with classical pedagogy. - The philosophy of education emphasizes formation through contemplation, wonder, and a sane balance of rest and rigor, consistent with scholé and contemplative aspects of classical teaching.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion; seminars; memory work; recitation; chanting; rites of pedagogy (scholé); rhetoric; wonder; formation; holistic education; consider restfulness and contemplation in pedagogy. - Negative keywords present: none observed in the materials reviewed; no evidence of an exclusively project-based/experiential-only approach that would conflict with the classical methods described.

Why this rating - The school explicitly describes a two-tier pedagogy (memory-oriented lower grades with chant and memorization; Socratic, seminar-based upper grades with rhetoric) and a structure that matches classical teaching methods. This is a strong CLASSICAL signal.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The governance and staffing information emphasize a leadership structure and a “living curriculum” in which faculty model virtue and knowledge; the presence of board leadership and a mission-focused staff description indicates teachers as exemplars and mentors, not merely technicians. Board pages and staff profiles underscore moral exemplarity and collegiality. - The policy and ethics sections describe a Code of Ethics and professional expectations, reinforcing teachers as moral guides and professionals who model classical virtues. - The Mission includes expectations that staff be nurturers and academic mentors, aligning with the “portrait of a teacher” and “living curriculum” concepts.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of what a teacher should be; faculty as core of the school; collegiality; mentorship; virtue; wisdom; devotion to Christian formation. - Negative keywords present: minimal or none (the materials emphasize virtue and mentorship rather than technocratic or impersonal teacher roles).

Why this rating - The materials describe teachers as exemplar models and mentors central to the school's identity, consistent with classical-faculty expectations. The presence of a formal board and leadership structure coupled with teacher-moral-formation emphasis supports CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school frames partnership with families as foundational, aiming to involve parents as co-teachers and to educate parents about classical education (parent formation, book studies, gatherings). The policy manual and mission statements emphasize parental involvement and accountability, with open campus and events. - The "In loco parentis" policy and multiple references to parental authority and collaboration indicate a deliberate home-school partnership, consistent with classical pedagogy that emphasizes the family's central role in formation. - The school's community orientation and church-life integration (Statement of Faith, governance by a board including church connections, and a community-based ethos) align with a classical model that sees families and churches as co-educators in a shared classical mission.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent formation; home-school partnership; open campus; parental involvement; parent-teacher collaboration; community of learners; classical family culture. - Negative keywords present: none detected in the public materials (no signals of consumerism or minimal family involvement; the opposite is emphasized).

Why this rating - Public-facing materials show a robust commitment to family partnership and parental involvement as co-educators, which is a key hallmark of classical education communities. This yields CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable here, as the school is classified CLASSICAL across all six categories. No major "needle-moving" changes are required to achieve a fully classical profile according to the rubric.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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